

GRAMMAR LESSON PLAN

Topic: Present Progressive (am / is / are + V-ing)
Grammar Focus: describing actions happening right now
Course: Community ESL (Novice High)
Lesson by : Shantona Mir
Length: 60 minutes

1. CONTEXT DESCRIPTION

Learners:

Community ESL adults, ages 19–65, mixed education backgrounds, Novice High according to ACTFL. Immigrants or international residents in the local community.

Purpose:

Students need the Present Progressive to describe everyday activities at home, work, (school if they want to pursue), and in the community. Examples:

- telling others what they're doing
- describing pictures/forms
- communicating at work ("I am cleaning the room.")
- explaining delays ("My kids are getting ready.")

Prior Knowledge (Assumptions):

Students can use simple present ("I work," "She cooks") and some basic verbs (cook, clean, study). They struggle to describe actions happening now and cannot yet form "am/is/are + -ing" accurately.

Learning Objectives:

By the end of the lesson, students will:

1. Recognize present progressive in visual contexts.
2. Notice the pattern am/is/are + verb-ing.
3. Form simple sentences using present progressive.
4. Use the form to describe real actions in short, meaningful interactions.

Photos for this lesson can be taken from: <https://www.pexels.com>

P — PRESENTATION (10 minutes)

(Comprehensible Input through a simple photo slideshow)

Time: 10 minutes

Purpose: give students clear examples of actions happening right now so they understand the meaning before noticing form.

Warm-Up: "What's Happening?" Prediction Activity (2–3 minutes)

Teacher shows 3–4 photos on the screen (no text):

- a woman cooking
- a man waiting for the bus
- kids playing

- a student writing

Instruction:

“Look at these pictures! Tell me, what do you SEE?”

Teacher Notes:
• Expect students to say 1–2 words only (cooking, playing, writing, waiting).
• Accept short answers; do NOT correct grammar.
• Point, mime, or act out the action to support comprehension.

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Instruction:

“Are these actions from yesterday, tomorrow, or happening right now?”

(wait for answers)

Giving Students a Purpose:

“Good! Today we are learning how to talk about things people are doing right at this moment. This will help you talk about what you, your family, and people in your community are doing in real life, at home, at work, or anywhere.”

Step 1: Setting Purpose (30 seconds)

Instruction:

“Now we will look at more pictures and talk about what people are doing right now. Just

Step 2: Photo Slideshow — Main Input (7 minutes)

Teacher shows 10 clear, real-life photos (one per slide).

Examples:

- a man cleaning
- children playing soccer
- a woman talking on the phone
- a student reading
- a man waiting for the bus
- a woman shopping
- a family eating dinner
- a man working on a computer

Instruction:

“Look at the picture. Listen.”

Teacher Modeling :

For each picture, teacher models the sentence twice:

- “She is cooking.” (gesture stirring)
- “She is cooking.”
- “He is waiting for the bus.” (gesture pointing to bus)
- “He is waiting for the bus.”
- “They are playing soccer.” (gesture kicking)
- “They are playing soccer.”

Student Response:

Students repeat together.

Step 3: Quick Comprehension Check (1–2 minutes)

Teacher shows a picture and asks simple choice questions:

- “Cooking or reading?”
- “Playing or sleeping?”
- “Waiting or walking?”

Students answer chorally.

Teacher confirms using a full, correct sentence:

- “Good! She is cooking.”
- “Yes! They are playing.”
- “Right, he is waiting.”

Teacher Notes for this Section:

- Use gestures (pointing, miming)
- Always repeat the correct sentence so students hear the full form again.
- Speak slowly and clearly
- Point to the person in the picture as you speak.
- Keep questions very short.
- Keep all input simple and short
- Encourage whole-group repetition only (no individual pressure).

A — ATTENTION (15 minutes)

Time: 15 minutes

Mode: Underlining, pattern-spotting, matching

Step 1: Underline the Form (5 minutes)

Teacher hands out a worksheet with six photo captions, like (In this case the caption can either be written on / behind the picture by the teacher or just find pictures with captions):

1. She is cooking.
2. They are playing soccer.
3. He is reading.
4. I am writing.
5. She is talking on the phone.
6. They are cleaning the kitchen.

Instruction:

“Underline the verb phrase, the part that shows the action happening now.”

Expected student findings:

- is cooking
- are playing
- is reading
- am writing
- is talking
- are cleaning

Step 2: Notice the Pattern (5 minutes)

Teacher asks simple guided questions:

- “What three small words do you see? (am / is / are)”
- “Where is the -ing?”
- “Does the -ing show now or every day?”

Students answer together.

Step 3: Match Subjects With Be-Verbs (5 minutes)

Teacher gives students 3 subject cards and 3 verb forms:

Subjects: I / He-She-It / You-We-They

Be-verbs: am / is / are

Students match them in pairs.

Teacher confirms with a model chart on the board:

I → am
He/She/It → is
You/We/They → are

C — CO-CONSTRUCTION (15 minutes)

Time: 15 minutes

Mode: teacher-led + student responses

Step 1: Build the Rule Chart (5 minutes)

Teacher draws:

Subject	Be-Verb	Verb + -ing
I	am	cooking
He / She	is	reading
They / We	are	playing

Instruction:

“So when we talk about now, we use: am / is / are + verb-ing.”

Step 2: Students Help Build Examples (5 minutes)

Teacher shows four photos again and asks:

“What is happening?”

Students produce:

- “She is cooking.”
- “They are working.”
- “He is eating.”

Teacher writes correct forms on the board.

Step 3: Controlled Accuracy Practice (5 minutes)

Students fix errors:

1. She cooking.
2. They is playing.
3. I are working.
4. He eating.
5. We is cleaning.

Students work in pairs , teacher checks correct answers.

E — EXTENSION (20 minutes)

Task: “Classroom Action Interview”

Students move around the room and interview classmates.

Step 1: Demonstration (1 minute)

Teacher models with a student:

A: "What are you doing?"

B: "I am writing."

Step 2: Student Interview Bingo(7 minutes)

Instruction: Now we will play a game. You will ask at least 5 classmates

"What are you doing?"

Your classmates answer using present progressive.

You write down the answers. If you get one wrong, you lose a point (emphasize the importance of the activity, so they try their best.)

Step 3: Group Report (6 minutes)

Students form groups of 3–4 of their choice, and write down as many "am/is/are +v-ing" as they can:

Example:

- "Maria is studying English."
- "Chen is writing."
- "Amina is reading."

Step 4: Presentations (6 minutes)

Groups share their mini-reports.

Listeners write down three sentences in the present progressive using new verbs they hear.

Exit Ticket : Then they write one sentence about themselves using present progressive.

6. PEDAGOGICAL RATIONALE (1–2 sentences per stage)

Presentation provides visual, comprehensible input that helps Novice-High learners understand actions happening right now before they focus on form.

Attention tasks guide learners to notice the pattern am/is/are + verb-ing through simple underlining and matching activities that strengthen form–meaning connections.

Co-construction allows students to help build the rule with familiar examples, reducing cognitive load and improving long-term retention.

Extension gives learners meaningful, real-world opportunities to use the structure in authentic communication, increasing confidence and fluency.

7. POST-IT NOTE VERSION (Quick Teaching Notes)

- Warm-up pictures - “What do you see?”
- Slideshow- model sentences (“She is cooking.”) + choral repetition
- Underline am / is / are + -ing in short captions
- Match subjects with be-verbs
- Build rule chart together
- Fix 5 incorrect sentences (controlled practice)
- Action Interview - “What are you doing?” - group mini-report
- Exit Ticket - 1 Present Progressive sentence about themselves

8. FEEDBACK SECTION

Marilyn

Lesson #3

This lesson was also very well done!

Some things I liked:

The rich input—use of pictures, actions, speaking, repetition, modeling correct syntax

Use of choral answers

Focus on simple language—yesterday/tomorrow/now for describing tense

The guidance in the teacher notes of how to communicate

Thoughtful input to take students from one step to the next